The Day of Atonement

Leviticus 10 · Leviticus 16 · Hebrews 9–10

The big idea: God is holy, and no one may come before him on his own terms. Once a year the high priest went behind the veil: one goat's blood covered the broken law, and the other carried the people's sins away. Jesus is priest and sacrifice, once for all.

Before you meet: Read

Leviticus 10:1–3 | Leviticus 16:1–22 | Hebrews 10:11–18

Open (5 minutes)

Is there something you keep trying to make up for, even after you have been forgiven?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"You shall be _____, for I the LORD your God am holy." *(Leviticus 19:2)*

"Aaron shall lay both his hands on the head of the live goat, and _____ over it all the iniquities of the people of Israel." *(Leviticus 16:21)*

"You shall be _____ before the LORD from all your sins." *(Leviticus 16:30)*

Christ "entered once for all into the holy places, not by means of the blood of goats and calves but by means of his own _____, thus securing an _____ redemption." *(Hebrews 9:12)*

Discuss

1. The two goats show sin paid for and sin carried away. Which of those do you most need to believe today? *Leviticus 16:15–22; Psalm 103:12*

2. If "it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sins," how were believers in Israel forgiven? How is their faith like yours? *Hebrews 10:4; Leviticus 4:31*

3. Every priest stood daily, but Christ sat down. What would change in your life if you really believed nothing is left to pay? *Hebrews 10:11–14, 18*

Memory verse

> *"But when Christ had offered for all time a single sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand of God."*
>
> **Hebrews 10:12**

Pray

Name your sins to God, one by one, and thank him that Christ has paid for them and carried them away. Rest in the finished work of the One who sat down.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 22

The Day of Atonement

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Leviticus 16:6–22 and Hebrews 10:11–14 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Numbers 13–14 and 21:4–9).

Main points to land

1. God is holy, and no one may come before him on his own terms (Leviticus 10:1–3; 19:2). His holiness also shapes ordinary life: love your neighbor as yourself (Leviticus 19:18).
2. On the Day of Atonement the blood of one goat covered the broken law in God's presence, and the other goat carried the people's sins away. Sin paid for and sin removed, but only for one year at a time (Leviticus 16:15–22, 34).
3. Jesus is both priest and sacrifice. He bore God's just anger as our propitiation and carried our sins away, once for all, then sat down. Faith receives this gift, and repentance always comes with it (Romans 3:25–26; Hebrews 10:12, 18).

Core doctrine to teach

Christ Our Substitute

CORE DOCTRINE 11 OF 26 · CHRIST ALONE

On the cross Jesus took the place of sinners. He bore the penalty our sins deserved and satisfied God's justice, so that God can forgive us and still be just. The Day of Atonement pictured it with two goats: one died, and one carried the people's sins away. *Leviticus 16:21–22; Isaiah 53:5–6; Romans 3:25–26; 2 Corinthians 5:21; 1 Peter 3:18*

Answer key (Observe)

1. holy
2. confess
3. clean
4. blood; eternal

Questions people will ask

What or who is Azazel?

The meaning of the Hebrew word is debated. It may mean the goat that goes away (Tyndale's scapegoat), a remote and desolate place, or a name for a wilderness demon. It was never a payment to the devil: both goats were presented before the LORD (16:7, 10). The picture is clear whatever the word means. The sins are carried away and do not come back.

Closing prayer

Holy Father, we cannot come to you on our own terms, and we have nothing to pay for our sins. Thank you for providing the Lamb. Thank you that Jesus bore your just anger in our place, carried our sins away, and sat down because the work is finished. Give each person here faith to trust him and a heart that turns from sin, and let us draw near to you with confidence. Amen.